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US$1B Hong Kong IAM eyes recruiting 20 RMs from top tier PBs by late 2023

By Carly Lau, reporter | 17 June 2022

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Blackhorn Wealth Management, a Hong Kong-based independent asset manager, has set out to triple its RM headcount by the end of 2023.

The firm was founded in August 2021 — when the Chinese property and technology sectors went through their worst performing periods — but it managed to book AUM of US$1 billion in less than 11 months, Yugi Lee, one of the founders of Blackhorn WM shared with *Asian Private Banker.*

"At present, we have six RMs, coming from top tier private banks. We expect to have 10 by the end of this year, and 20 by end of 2023," Lee, an-ex UBS private banker said.

"Our core focus is to serve UHNW clients and families. The reason we actively hire private bankers is that we want to bring the right people to clients," she explained. "People from any other background simply do not suit our model." Lee feels that experienced private bankers have a deeper understanding of the needs of PB clients.

The firm recently hired **Wong Po Sum** as executive director. Wong came from UBS, where he had been a director for 13 years. He worked at Hang Seng Bank before joining UBS.

Danika Ma joined Blackhorn WM as director. She too hailed from UBS, where she was most recently associate director.

Gregory Ng has been appointed as director. He used to be with Morgan Stanley and UBS from 2015 to 2020 focused on serving HNW clients.

"Clients normally prefer to stick with their RMs for a very long time, so our strategy is to bring more senior private bankers with sizeable books," she highlighted. "Apart from relationship management, we emphasise portfolio management; so our RMs can handle portfolio management jobs as well here."

A core part of what Blackhorn WM does is managing client portfolios on a discretionary basis.

To minimise losses in client portfolios, the investment committee uses a variety of hedging tools, Lee said.

"We started early to short US treasury and long US oil, which played out well in client portfolios," she said. "This is how we differ from PBs, because PBs are not so involved in hedging and short positions. Also, the services offered by PBs are more product-driven, which gives RMs joining us more flexibility too."

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